

Sourcing Analysis with AI

A recruitment funnel analysis built with Excel, pivot tables, and Claude (Anthropic) on a 601-candidate dataset.

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601	49	8.2%	31.1 days
Candidates	Hired	Conversion rate	Avg. time to hire

Main finding — The recruitment funnel is healthy through every stage until Test to Offer, where only 31% of candidates who complete the test receive an offer. This single bottleneck has more impact than any sourcing optimization.

601 candidates · 8 sourcing channels · 4 roles · 6 recruiters · 4 seniority levels · 3 work modes.

1. Introduction

This project analyzes a fictional recruitment dataset to answer five questions: which sourcing strategies convert best, what signals indicate a higher chance of advancing, when it is worth persisting with a candidate, when there is low probability of conversion, and what patterns exist among channels, recruiters, and candidate profiles.

Before the analysis, it is worth noting that the dataset combines two different concepts in a single column: sourcing channel (where the candidate was found — LinkedIn, Github, Comunidade, Banco de Talentos, Evento, Indicação) and sourcing motion (how they entered the funnel — Inbound meaning the candidate applied proactively, Outbound/Hunting meaning the recruiter actively sourced them).

This limits the depth of the analysis. A recruiter can hunt through LinkedIn, Github, or Comunidade, but in the current structure Hunting appears as a standalone channel, making it impossible to know which platform it came from. The same applies to Inbound, which describes candidate behavior rather than a specific source. Results are presented as-is to preserve data integrity, with this limitation in mind. A separate column capturing sourcing motion would allow comparisons such as "Outbound via LinkedIn vs Outbound via Github," which is currently invisible in the data.

Note — The dataset contains two roles, Analista de Recrutamento and Talent Acquisition Specialist, that may overlap in scope depending on the company's internal structure. The data was kept as-is without merging the two, but this should be validated before drawing role-specific conclusions.

2. Data Preparation, AI and Tooling

Logical columns (TRUE/FALSE) were transformed into numeric values (1/0) to enable correct extraction of metrics. A time-to-fill column was added, calculated as the difference between the hired date and the first contact date, to enable time-based analysis by channel and position.

AI was used in all stages of this project. Claude (Anthropic) helped surface insights that would require significant time to extract manually in a spreadsheet — for example, identifying that candidates scoring 75 or above across all three evaluations are most likely to get hired, and structuring qualitative data such as rejection reasons into analyzable categories. Claude also supported the development of this document and the interactive dashboard, and helped optimize the overall workflow.

The interactive dashboard was built in HTML with AI assistance. Excel and pivot tables were the primary tool for data exploration and validation throughout the project.

Key decisions

- Preserving data integrity over manipulation — channels were not merged or recategorized even where overlaps were identified. The limitation was documented instead.
- Excluding low-sample results from recommendations — any channel/role combination with fewer than 15 candidates was treated with caution and excluded from primary recommendations.
- Focusing on the Test to Offer bottleneck — the biggest drop happens after the test, not at sourcing, which reframed the recommendations around evaluation criteria rather than sourcing volume.

3. Which Sourcing Strategies Convert Best?

The analysis was conducted across six dimensions: overall hire conversion rate, conversion by position, response rate, time to hire, funnel efficiency, and volume vs quality tradeoff.

3.1 Github and Inbound are the strongest channels overall

They lead in conversion rate (11% and 10.1%), maintain lean pipelines, and close at average speed. Evento (4.9%) and Indicação (4.7%) show the weakest conversion, worth reconsidering given the volume they generate with little return.

Channel	Total	Hired	Hire Rate	Response Rate
Github	73	8	11.0%	68.5%
Inbound	69	7	10.1%	79.7%
Hunting	75	7	9.3%	64.0%
Banco de Talentos	68	6	8.8%	75.0%
LinkedIn	81	7	8.6%	63.0%
Comunidade	89	7	7.9%	67.4%
Evento	82	4	4.9%	67.1%
Indicação	64	3	4.7%	59.4%

3.2 Channel choice should vary by position

Role	Best Channel	Hire Rate
Analista de Dados	Hunting / LinkedIn	13%
Analista de Recrutamento	Banco de Talentos	21%
People BP	Comunidade	15%
Talent Acquisition Specialist	LinkedIn	15%

These rankings could shift if sourcing channel and sourcing motion were properly distinguished — Github and Hunting likely represent outbound motion rather than standalone channels, and LinkedIn can operate as both inbound and outbound depending on use.

3.3 Inbound is the most consistent engagement signal

Inbound leads response rate overall at 80%, followed by Banco de Talentos (75%) and Github (68%). By position: Analista de Dados via LinkedIn reaches 83%, Analista de Recrutamento via Inbound reaches 94% (the highest in the dataset), People BP via Inbound 77%, Talent Acquisition Specialist via Inbound 80%.

3.4 Time to hire

Average time to hire is 31.1 days. For urgent roles, prioritize Banco de Talentos (28.7d) and Comunidade (29.7d). Avoid LinkedIn for time-sensitive openings — 36.6 days on average, nearly a week longer than the fastest channels.

Channel	Avg. Days to Hire
Banco de Talentos	28.7
Comunidade	29.7
Github	30.4
Hunting	30.4
Inbound	30.4
Indicação	30.5
Evento	31.8
LinkedIn	36.6

3.5 The bottleneck is not sourcing, it is the Test to Offer decision

Stage	Conversion
Candidate → Response	68%
Response → Screening	75%
Screening → Interview	76%
Interview → Test	86%
Test → Offer	31%
Offer → Hired	79%

Critical finding — The funnel is healthy and consistent through every stage until the test, then collapses at Test to Offer (31%). This is the single biggest bottleneck in the process.

By channel, Test to Offer rates range from 42% (Github) to 21% (Evento). Channels with the lowest Test to Offer rate — Banco de Talentos and LinkedIn — show 100% offer acceptance, meaning recruiters are highly selective before extending offers but candidates always accept once they do. By role, Analista de Dados has the worst Test to Offer rate (24%) despite a 90% interview pass rate, while Talent Acquisition Specialist loses the most at offer acceptance (64%, the lowest in the dataset).

3.6 Focus where the quality is

High candidate volume does not equal high hiring efficiency. Evento and Indicação generate meaningful volume with the lowest conversion rates, consuming recruiter time without proportional return. Redirecting effort toward Github and Inbound is the more efficient path.

4. What Signals Indicate a Higher Chance of Advancing?

4.1 High scores on the evaluations

The combination of all three evaluation scores (technical, behavior, manager) at or above 75 is the strongest predictor of hire. Candidates meeting this threshold convert at 21% vs 4% for those below — a 5x difference, useful as a fast-track flag in high-volume processes.

Score Threshold	Candidates	Hire Rate
Below 75 (any score)	460	4%
All 3 scores $\geq$ 75	141	21%

4.2 Seniority follows a linear pattern, and so do recruiters

More senior candidates convert at higher overall hire rates: Staff 13%, Senior 10%, Pleno 7%, Junior 5%. The initial assumption was that Junior candidates drop out earlier — the funnel data told a different story.

Seniority	Hire Rate	Test → Offer	Offer → Hire
Junior	5%	17%	83%
Pleno	7%	26%	76%
Senior	10%	38%	80%
Staff	13%	50%	80%

Junior candidates progress through response, screening, interview, and test at rates comparable to senior profiles. The gap appears exclusively at Test to Offer — only 17% of Juniors receive an offer, vs 50% for Staff. Once an offer is made, acceptance is consistent across all seniority levels (~80%). The bottleneck is an internal offer decision, not candidate dropout.

The same pattern holds across recruiters: scores are consistent (~73–75 average) team-wide, yet Bruno converts 42% of test-takers to offers with 100% acceptance, while Fernanda converts only 19% — despite similarly scored candidates.

Recommendation — If a role requires a minimum seniority level, apply that filter earlier in the funnel.

5. When is it Worth Persisting with a Candidate?

Candidates who progress through the funnel consistently are significantly more likely to convert. Engagement is the clearest behavioral signal available to recruiters.

Persist when:

- The candidate responded to first contact and is actively communicating
- They progressed through screening and interview without significant delays
- Evaluation scores show a reasonable average across all three assessments
- All 3 scores are ≥ 75 — fast-track immediately
- The candidate reached the test stage — significant investment already made

Stop persisting when:

- No response after first contact and one follow-up (32% of pipeline, virtually zero hires)
- The candidate failed screening — profile mismatch rarely recovers
- Scores are consistently low across all three evaluations (4% hire rate)
- A salary mismatch is flagged early — address before offer stage, not after

Stage Reached	Recommendation
No response	Deprioritize after one follow-up
Responded, failed screening	Drop — profile mismatch
Passed screening, pending interview	One follow-up to confirm interest
Passed interview, pending test	Persist — investment already made
Completed test, average scores	Evaluate carefully before discarding
All 3 scores ≥ 75	Fast-track

6. When is There Low Probability of Conversion?

The most reliable signal is no response after first contact — 32% of the pipeline never replies, contributing virtually zero hires. Candidates who fail screening rarely recover, and candidates with consistently low scores across all three evaluations convert at only 4%.

Some channel and role combinations produced zero hires despite significant volume:

- Banco de Talentos and Evento → Analista de Dados
- Github and Hunting → Talent Acquisition Specialist
- LinkedIn → People BP
- Indicação → Talent Acquisition Specialist

Action — These combinations should be treated as deprioritization rules before investing sourcing effort.

7. Patterns Among Channels, Recruiters and Profiles

7.1 Recruiter performance varies up to 4x

Recruiter	Total	Hired	Hire Rate	Response Rate	Test→Offer	Offer→Hire
Bruno	98	15	15.3%	69%	42%	100%
Ana	75	10	13.3%	79%	37%	77%
Carla	101	9	8.9%	64%	38%	75%
Gustavo	121	6	5.0%	67%	26%	55%
Diego	103	5	4.9%	68%	21%	83%
Fernanda	103	4	3.9%	63%	19%	80%

Scores are consistent across recruiters (~73–75 average), so the 4x gap between Bruno (15%) and Fernanda (4%) reflects internal decision-making, not candidate quality. Bruno achieves 100% offer acceptance. Gustavo manages the largest pipeline (121 candidates) but loses nearly half at offer stage (55% acceptance), suggesting expectation misalignment rather than a sourcing problem.

7.2 Recruiters specialize by role

Recruiter	Best Role	Rate	Zero-hire Role
Bruno	Analista de Recrutamento	22%	—
Ana	People BP	19%	—
Carla	Analista de Recrutamento	24%	—
Diego	People BP	7%	Talent Acquisition Specialist
Fernanda	Talent Acquisition Specialist	11%	People BP
Gustavo	People BP	8%	Talent Acquisition Specialist

Diego and Gustavo together managed 49 Talent Acquisition Specialist candidates with zero hires. Formalizing role specialization — Bruno and Carla to Analista de Recrutamento, Ana to People BP, Fernanda to Talent Acquisition Specialist — could improve conversion without additional sourcing investment.

7.3 Indicação (referrals) underperforms every other channel

Counterintuitive finding — Referrals are usually assumed to be high quality. The data contradicts this: Indicação has the worst conversion rate (4.7%) and the lowest response rate (59%) in the dataset, suggesting the referral process may lack qualification criteria.

8. Work Mode Analysis

Work mode significantly impacts conversion. Híbrido leads with a 10.8% hire rate and 73% response rate. Presencial follows at 8.8% and 68%. Remoto shows the weakest results on both — 5.0% and 63% — suggesting the engagement problem starts at first contact, not at evaluation.

Work Mode	Hire Rate	Response Rate
Híbrido	10.8%	73%
Presencial	8.8%	68%
Remoto	5.0%	63%

Channel effectiveness changes with work mode

LinkedIn converts at 17% for Presencial roles but only 3% for Remoto. Github Híbrido reaches 20%, the highest combination in the dataset. Comunidade and Hunting show zero hires for Remoto roles.

Channel	Work Mode	Hire Rate
Github	Híbrido	20%
Hunting	Híbrido	18%
LinkedIn	Presencial	17%
LinkedIn	Remoto	3%
Comunidade	Remoto	0%
Hunting	Remoto	0%
Evento	Remoto	11%

The remote drop is especially severe for Analista de Dados (1.9%) and Talent Acquisition Specialist (2.4%). Junior Remoto (2%) is almost impossible to hire, while Staff Presencial (20%) is the strongest seniority and mode combination overall.

Recommendation — For remote openings, prioritize LinkedIn and Banco de Talentos.

9. Rejection Reasons

Headline — No response is the #1 rejection reason across all roles and seniority levels, accounting for 38% of all rejections — a sourcing and engagement problem, not an evaluation problem.

By role

Role	No Response	2nd Reason	3rd Reason
Analista de Dados	31%	Salary mismatch (6.6%)	Failed tech test (6%)
Analista de Recrutamento	35%	Timing mismatch (6.2%)	Low engagement (4.6%)
People BP	43%	Low engagement (5.3%)	Failed tech test (4.6%)
Talent Acquisition Specialist	44%	Accepted another offer (5%)	Headcount closed (5%)

By seniority

Seniority	No Response	Notable Pattern
Junior	36%	Accepted another offer (5.8%) — competitive market
Pleno	40%	Timing mismatch (5.7%) — availability issues
Senior	38%	Salary mismatch (4.3%) — higher expectations
Staff	39%	Headcount closed (5.8%) — roles cancelled mid-process

Actionable conclusions

Rejection Reason	Where it Hurts Most	Recommendation
No response	People BP, Talent Acquisition	Personalize first contact; one follow-up max
Salary mismatch	Analista de Dados, Senior	Revisit salary competitiveness, not just timing
Accepted another offer	Junior, Talent Acquisition	Reduce time to offer for competitive profiles
Timing mismatch	Analista de Recrutamento, Pleno	Confirm availability and notice period upfront
Headcount closed	Staff	Require confirmed headcount before opening senior roles
Low engagement	People BP	Use higher-touch sourcing; cold outreach may not work

10. Key Insights

1. The bottleneck is not sourcing, it is the Test to Offer decision

Only 31% of candidates who complete the test receive an offer — the highest-impact improvement opportunity in the process.

2. Github and Inbound are the most efficient channels overall, but channel choice should vary by role

No universal best channel exists. Banco de Talentos for Analista de Recrutamento (21%), LinkedIn for Talent Acquisition Specialist and Analista de Dados (13–15%), Comunidade for People BP (15%).

3. Inbound is the most consistent engagement signal across the dataset

Candidates who apply proactively show higher response rates, progress further, and accept offers at higher rates.

4. Candidate scores are the strongest predictor of hire

Candidates scoring ≥ 75 across all three evaluations are 5x more likely to be hired.

5. Work mode impacts conversion as much as channel choice

Híbrido converts at 10.8% vs 5.0% for Remoto. LinkedIn at 17% Presencial vs 3% Remoto.

6. Indicação (referrals) underperforms every other channel

Worst conversion (4.7%) and lowest response rate (59%) — contradicting the assumption that referrals are higher quality.

7. Recruiter performance varies up to 4x, driven by decisions, not candidate quality

Bruno (15%) vs Fernanda (4%), despite consistent candidate scores across the team.

8. The dataset has structural limitations that reduce analytical precision

Sourcing channel and motion are mixed in one column; two role titles may overlap in scope.

11. Recommendations for Recruiters

Sourcing

- Prioritize Github and Inbound for most roles.
- Match channel to role: Banco de Talentos for Analista de Recrutamento, LinkedIn for Talent Acquisition Specialist and Analista de Dados, Comunidade for People BP.
- Deprioritize Evento and Indicação — redirect effort toward Github, Inbound, or role-specific channels.
- For urgent roles, avoid LinkedIn (36.6 days average); start with Banco de Talentos or Comunidade.
- For remote openings, prioritize LinkedIn and Banco de Talentos.

Pipeline Management

- Stop chasing non-responders after one follow-up.
- Flag candidates with all 3 scores ≥ 75 as high priority.
- Apply seniority filters early in the funnel if a role has a minimum level requirement.

Offer Stage

- Review Test to Offer decision criteria — this is where the funnel breaks.
- For Analista de Dados: revisit salary bands — the issue may be offer attractiveness, not qualification.
- For Talent Acquisition Specialist: reduce time to offer and address salary expectations earlier.

Team Structure

- Formalize role specialization: Bruno and Carla to Analista de Recrutamento, Ana to People BP, Fernanda to Talent Acquisition Specialist.
- Investigate what Bruno does differently — particularly relevant for Gustavo's low offer acceptance (55%).
- Avoid opening Staff-level roles without confirmed headcount approval.

Data Collection

- Add a sourcing motion column (Inbound vs Outbound) to future datasets.
- Validate whether Analista de Recrutamento and Talent Acquisition Specialist are genuinely distinct roles.